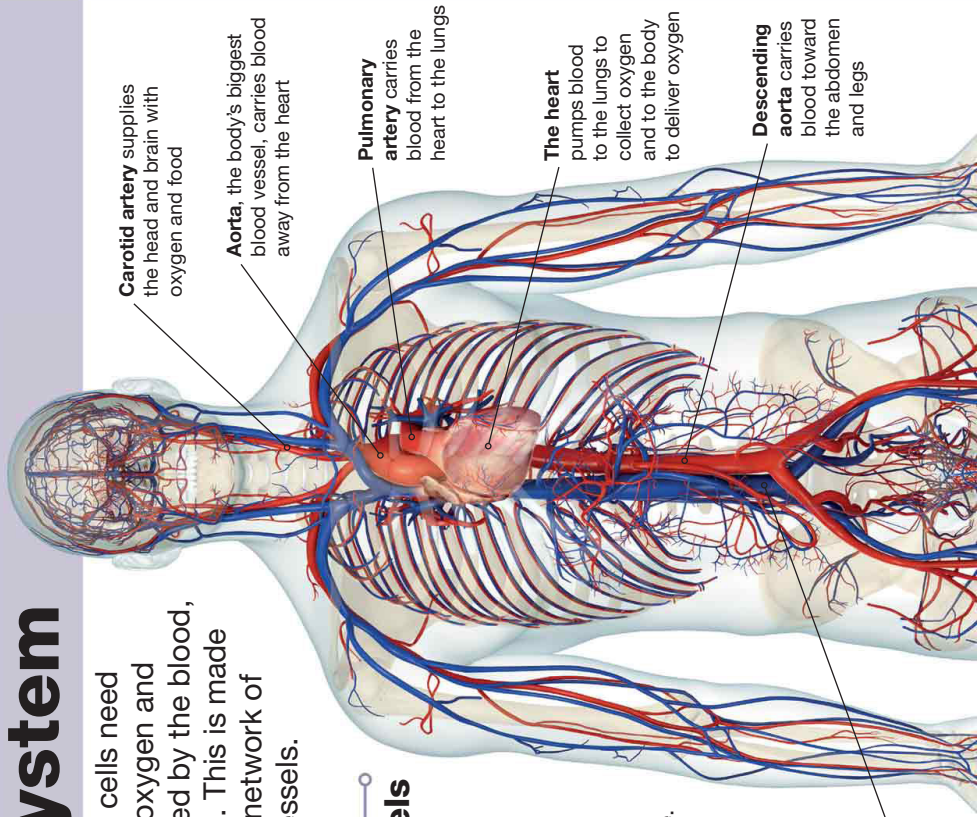


Blood system

The body's trillions of cells need a constant supply of oxygen and food, which is provided by the blood, or circulatory, system. This is made up of the heart and a network of tubes called blood vessels.

Network of vessels

Blood vessels carry blood to every part of the body, from head to toe. Arteries (shown in red) carry blood away from the heart. Veins (shown in blue) carry blood back to the heart. They are linked by tiny capillaries that are too small to be seen here.



Carotid artery supplies the head and brain with oxygen and food

Aorta, the body's biggest blood vessel, carries blood away from the heart

Pulmonary artery carries blood from the heart to the lungs

The heart pumps blood to the lungs to collect oxygen and to the body to deliver oxygen

Descending aorta carries blood toward the abdomen and legs

Inferior vena cava carries blood from the abdomen and legs to the heart